Characteristic Features

- North Indian cuisines usually have thick, moderately spicy and creamy gravies.
- Use of dried fruits and nuts is fairly common even in everyday foods.
- Dairy products like milk, cream, cottage cheese, ghee and yoghurt play an important role in the cooking of both savory and sweet dishes.
- This region is famous for tandoori roti and naans, stuffed parathas and kulchas.
- Basmati rice in the form of jeera rice and pulaos are common.
- Popular dishes are mutter paneer, chaat, dhokla, dhalmakhani, samosas and so on.



▲ Plate 7.11 Thali

2. South Indian Cuisine: South Indian cuisine includes the five southern states of India: Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamilnadu and Telungana.

Characteristic Features

- Rice is a staple food in South Indian Cuisine.
- The cuisines have common ingredients and differ primarily in the spiciness of the food.
- Millets used commonly in rural areas are becoming popular in urban region too.
- Some authentic and popular South Indian dishes like pongal, sambar and vadai are from Tamilnadu, rava idli from Karnataka, kadalai curry and appam from Kerala and kebabs and biriyani from Andhra Pradesh.



▲ Plate 7.12 South Indian Cuisine

Ingredients used in North Indian Cuisine

Vegetable oil, mustard oil, spices, cheese, paneer, wheat products, black pepper, garam masala, fleshy foods, saffron.

Ingredients used in South Indian Cuisine

Rice, wheat, millets, coconut, ginger, garlic, pulses, greens, masala powders, ghee, vegetable oils, fruits and vegetables, spices.

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